



Maintain product information inventory

D2.TTA.CL2.12

Assessor Manual



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Assessor Manual



Specialist centre
for foods, tourism
& hospitality

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

“At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.

These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:

 - You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: MAINTAIN PRODUCT INFORMATION INVENTORY		NOMINAL HOURS: 30
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTA.CL2.12		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to maintain and use a product information inventory to support the effective operation of a travel and tourism business. It does not relate to the provision of product information to clients.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA	UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE	
Element 1: Identify the function of product information inventory in the travel and tourism business 1.1 Describe the <i>role of product information inventories</i> 1.2 List the <i>businesses</i> involved with <i>product information inventories</i> 1.3 Identify the <i>formats of product information inventories</i> Element 2: Source and interpret products and information for inventory 2.1 Identify information that may be entered onto a product information inventory 2.2 <i>Request businesses</i> to supply required product information 2.3 <i>Interpret product information</i> received from <i>businesses</i>	Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to the maintenance and use of a product information inventory to support the effective operation of a travel and tourism business within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel Agencies 2. Tour Operation <i>Role of product information inventories</i> may be related to: • Providing a readily accessible and current database of information that staff can use in their selling endeavours • Optimising the potential for staff to make accurate bookings and sales that best comply with identified client requests • Enabling staff to respond professionally to client requests for information.	

2.4 <i>Review and evaluate product information</i> 2.5 Obtain <i>additional product information</i>, where necessary Element 3: Enter product information onto inventory systems 3.1 Load data onto the product information inventory system in accordance with <i>host enterprise policies and procedures</i> 3.2 Verify completeness, accuracy and currency of information entered onto the product information inventory Element 4: Update product information inventory 4.1 <i>Monitor product information inventory</i> 4.2 Request <i>additional allocations</i> 4.3 Remove <i>information</i> from product information inventory 4.4 <i>Input up-dates and other product information changes</i> as they arrive Element 5: Supply inventory information 5.1 Identify <i>internal personnel</i> to whom product inventory information advice may be provided 5.2 Identify <i>frequency</i> with which product inventory information advice may be provided	<i>Businesses</i> may include: • Travel suppliers, including airlines, cruise operators, railway operators, bus lines, car rental businesses, limousine hire and taxis • Suppliers and providers of support and ancillary services, including travel insurance providers, finance providers, currency exchange, conference and similar venues, interpreters • Tour operators and wholesalers • Travel agencies and associations • Peak travel bodies • Government tourism industry bodies and authorities, including domestic and international bodies • The host enterprise, including identification of department and individuals within the host enterprise who are involved in this. <i>Product information</i> may include: • Travel, including air, cruise, train, bus, car • Destinations, including statistical information and details relating to climate, currency, maps, travel guides, events, languages, history, safety, government information, time zones, culture and communications • Tourist activities and attractions, including natural and man-made • Tours, trips, sight-seeing and excursions • Accommodation facilities, ranging from five-star to back-packer venues and including blocked dates, seasons and times, minimum purchase, use, booking and stay requirements, where applicable • Services, including medical, personal, entertainment, sporting, shopping
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5.3 Prepare and distribute <i>reports</i> and product information to internal personnel 5.4 Provide <i>assistance to internal personnel</i>	• Travel requirements, including requirements relating to entry, passport, visas, warnings and advisory bulletins, customs information • Finance and travel insurance • Allotments of any type of tourism product, including accommodation, seats, entry passes • Rates, costs and tariffs, including details relating to specials, packages, discounts, peak and low season rates, premiums, commissions and group rates • General product information, including venue and local area and facilities information • Terms and conditions of sale, including details that apply to the business and to clients/purchasers • Sales data, including internal tracking of sales together with up-dated sales data from suppliers to assist with identifying allotments that remain for sale. <i>Formats of product information inventories may include:</i> • Manual systems • Computerised systems • Combination of the above. <i>Request businesses may relate to:</i> • Telephoning targeted businesses • Making face-to-face requests of sales staff that visit the office • Making e-mail requests • Registering to receive information, newsletters and up-dates.
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	<i>Interpret product information</i> may include: • Understanding resources, including interpreting codes, abbreviations, acronyms and individual supplier terminology • Converting currencies • Interpreting terms and conditions • Understanding limitations and elements of products and services, especially packages and deals • Identifying fees and charges • Using international time in accordance with a 24-hour clock. <i>Review and evaluate product information</i> may include: • Assessing currency of the information provided • Determining degree of usefulness of the information • Identifying new information that is needed to supplement existing product information • Considering the applicability of information to client queries and needs • Judging accuracy and honesty of the information provided by suppliers. <i>Additional product information</i> may include: • Making telephone calls and/or sending e-mails to individual suppliers • Internet research • Interrogation of the internal database • Asking network of contacts.
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	<i>Host enterprise policies and procedures</i> may include: • Timing of data entry and up-dates, including up-date schedules • Authorities to enter data, including designation of individuals and positions within the business • Identification of specific data that must and must not be entered onto the system • Complying with operational requirements of the data system, including log on procedures, system integrity, fields to be used, file creation procedures, file naming protocols and system security requirements • Version controls to note dates material was last edited/up-dated. <i>Monitor product information inventory</i> may include: • Assessing completeness, accuracy and currency of the product information • Verifying source of information • Monitoring bookings, allotments/allocations and requests • Ensuring regular up-dates in accordance with supplier schedules and seasonal demands • Ensuring all products and services offered are supported by suitable and sufficient product information inventory. <i>Additional allocations</i> may include contacting suppliers and support services to organise extra allocations to meet: • One-off peak load demand • General trends indicating increased demand.
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	<i>Remove information</i> may relate to: • Deleting information regarding products and services that have been removed from the service menu • Over-writing dated information with revised information • Removing out-of-date information • Complying with designated host enterprise guidelines, including guidelines and requirements imposed by suppliers • Removing hard copy material that supports and reflects product information inventory data. <i>Input up-dates and other product information</i> may include: • Adding new information as soon as possible to ensure currency of product information inventory • Ensuring related hard copy material is removed and/or amended, including promotional material and hard copy information used by staff for selling activities • Ensuring accuracy of data entry. <i>Internal personnel</i> may include: • Head office • Managers, supervisors and owners • Sales staff, including counter-staff, ticketing officers and other client-contact staff • Marketing department • Accounting department, including individual responsible for price setting.
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	<i>Frequency</i> may relate to: • Prepared schedules for disseminating internal information, including staff briefings, schedules staff meetings and management meetings • Complying with immediate demand where no prior notice exists. <i>Reports</i> may include: • Sales reports • Reservation reports • Cost comparisons for various product suppliers • Features and benefits comparisons for various product suppliers and/or packages • Usage rates for various product suppliers and individual products and/or services • General management tools to track and evaluate business performance in conjunction with financial reports. <i>Assistance to internal personnel</i> may include: • Providing information as required • Clarifying information and information that is potentially conflicting • Making recommendations • Verifying information sourced by staff. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Enterprise policies and procedures in regard to sourcing and maintaining product information both internally and externally • Knowledge of the role of product information inventories in industry
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	• Knowledge of major categories of tourism products and services • Knowledge of industry products, product information and rate options and variations • Industry terminology, jargon and abbreviations • Ability to convert to and from international time • Ability to produce and interpret product information inventory reports • Ability to calculate rates. Linkages To Other Units • Access and interpret product information • Access and retrieve computer-based data • Develop and update local knowledge • Maintain quality customer/guest service • Use common business tools and technology • Develop and update tourism industry knowledge • Promote products and services to customers • Operate a computerised reservation system • Source and provide destination information and advice • Construct and apply tourism product research • Promote tourism products and services.
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	Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Understanding of current and potential sources of information that can be used within the product information inventory of the host enterprise in-line with the products and services offered by that business • Demonstrated ability to obtain and interpret product information to support a nominated suite of products and services offered by the host enterprise • Demonstrated ability to create, up-date, review, evaluate, amend and maintain product information inventory files for a nominated suite of products and services offered by the host enterprise • Demonstrated ability to calculate costs relating to nominated items of product information for products and services offered by the host enterprise • Demonstrated ability to secure additional allocations from suppliers for a nominated suite of products and services offered by the host enterprise • Demonstrated ability to produce a set of nominated reports to support, track and/or explain designated aspects of sales for given products and services offered by the host enterprise • Demonstrated ability to provide assistance to personnel in relation to nominated aspects of data contained within the product information inventory of the host enterprise. Context of Assessment Assessment must ensure: • Simulated or actual workplace for the application of techniques to maintain product inventory information.
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	Resource Implications Training and assessment must include the use of real equipment, databases, facilities and product information; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Observation of practical candidate performance • Case studies • Simulated exercises • Role plays • Portfolio of reports, database up-dates, inventory documentation and resources to support the maintenance and operation of a product information inventory • Oral and written questions • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work. Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>
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	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	3	Obtain, evaluate and synthesise product information
	Communicating ideas and information	3	Communicate with suppliers to obtain and clarify product information; explain product information to colleagues
	Planning and organising activities	2	Schedule reviews and product information up-dates
	Working with others and in teams	2	Supply responses to queries from colleagues; liaise with internal and external personnel to maintain currency and accuracy of the product information inventory
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	3	Calculate costs
	Solving problems	1	Resolve issues relating to currency, accuracy, honesty, completeness and applicability of product information
	Using technology	2	Use database technologies to record and modify product information inventories

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Maintain product information inventory D2.TTA.CL2.12
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Why is it important to have product knowledge if you work in the tourism and travel industries?	☐	☐
2. Why is it important to identify different tourism businesses before collecting product information?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. What are the objectives of establishing a product information storage system?	☐	☐
4. What airline related product information would you like to collect as a travel agent?	☐	☐
5. What are considerations when requesting product information from tourism businesses?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What is the purpose of interpreting product information?	☐	☐
7. Why is it important to review and evaluate product information?	☐	☐
8. Why would you need to obtain additional product information from suppliers?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. What is the purpose of a 'Global Distribution System'?	☐	☐
10. Why is it important to verify the completeness, accuracy and currency of product information received?	☐	☐
11. Why is it important to keep product information inventories up to date?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. What are strategies you can use for handling low levels of product information inventories?	☐	☐
13. Why is it important that 'out-dated' information or inaccurate copies of brochures be removed immediately?	☐	☐
14. What are the benefits of 'updating' product information as opposed to replacing all information?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. What are roles and responsibilities that may be allocated to internal personnel in the management and upkeep of product information inventories?	☐	☐
16. What are considerations when identifying the frequency in passing on product information to internal personnel?	☐	☐
17. Why is it important to communicate new product information to staff on a regular basis?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. What are reasons for providing assistance to staff after you have given them new product information?	☐	☐

Written questions

Maintain product information inventory – D2.TTA.CL2.12

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What is product information?

2. What are the roles of product information inventories?

3. What are three examples of tourism transportation businesses?

4. What are three examples of tourism accommodation businesses?

5. Besides transportation and accommodation businesses, identify three other types of tourism related businesses.

6. What are examples of different formats in which to receive product information?

7. What is an example of a 'computerised' system which can be used to collect and store product information?

8. What are examples of 'destination' information you would like to collect?

9. What are examples of 'local community' information you would like to collect?

10. What are examples of 'accommodation' information you would like to collect?

11. What are objectives when contacting tourism businesses for product information?

12. What are ways to make contact with tourism businesses?

13. What are methods used to interpret product information?

14. What is the purpose of reviewing and evaluating product information you have received?

15. What are methods used to obtain additional product information?

16. Besides contacting suppliers, what are sources of additional product information?

17. What are considerations when loading product information into your inventory systems?

18. What are examples of manual filing systems?

19. What methods can be used to ensure the accuracy of product information received?

20. How can you monitor product information inventory?

21. How can you monitor current issues relating to the travel and tourism?

22. What are reasons for needing additional allocations or brochures from a supplier?

23. What are methods use to remove out-dated product information?

24. What are some ways suppliers may want you to remove their brochures from your offices?

25. What are reasons for updating product information inventories?

26. What are ways to input up-dates and other product information into existing product information inventories?

27. Who are internal personnel whom may use product information inventories?

28. Provide examples of how frequent product information should be passed to staff.

29. What are methods used to communicate new product information to staff?

30. What are examples of assistance you can provide to staff after you have given them new product information?

Answers to written questions

Maintain product information inventory – D2.TTA.CL2.12

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. What is product information?

Product information is all information relating to tourism operations including the products and services they provide.

2. What are the roles of product information inventories?

- Providing a readily accessible and current database of information that staff can use in their selling endeavours
- Optimising the potential for staff to make accurate bookings and sales that best comply with identified client requests
- Enabling staff to respond professionally to client requests for information.

3. What are three examples of tourism transportation businesses?

- Airlines
- Cruise operators
- Railway operators
- Bus lines
- Car rental businesses
- Limousine hire
- Taxis.

4. What are three examples of tourism accommodation businesses?

- Hotels and motels
- Guest houses
- Bed and breakfasts
- Caravan parks and camping grounds
- Resorts
- Time share properties
- Apartments, villas and cottages
- Conference and exhibition centres.

5. Besides transportation and accommodation businesses, identify three other types of tourism related businesses.

- Attractions and theme parks
- Tour operators
- Inbound Tour Wholesaler
- Outbound Tour Wholesale
- Retail Travel Agents
- Local, regional and National information services
- Meetings and Events
- Corporate Agents
- Ministries of Tourism
- Tourism boards
- Industry authorities
- Industry associations
- Other product information sources.

6. What are examples of different formats in which to receive product information?

- Brochures, flyers and pamphlets
- Product manuals
- Supplier information and sales kits
- Confidential and general industry tariffs
- Preferred contracts or agreements
- Clue cards
- Fare sheets
- Industry publications, advices and notices
- Videos
- Posters
- Timetables
- Atlases and maps
- Travel literature
- Travel Guides
- Newspapers and magazines
- Internal databases.
- Online product training modules.

- 7. What is an example of a 'computerised' system which can be used to collect and store product information?**
 - Internet websites
 - Computerised Reservation System (CRS)
 - Global Distribution Systems (GDS).
- 8. What are examples of 'destination' information you would like to collect?**
 - General destination information
 - Statistical information
 - Currency
 - Maps
 - Travel guides
 - Events
 - Languages
 - Safety
 - Government information
 - Time zones
 - Communications.
- 9. What are examples of 'local community' information you would like to collect?**
 - Local attractions
 - Shopping and retail areas
 - Events and festivals
 - Eateries
 - Supermarkets
 - Local transport
 - Activities
 - Places of worship.

10. What are examples of 'accommodation' information you would like to collect?

- Room types
- Tariffs
- Products and services
- Room facilities
- Location and distance to attractions
- Packages
- Blocked dates
- Seasons and times
- Minimum purchase
- Booking and stay requirements
- Property name and address
- Room type and category
- Number of nights
- Check-in and check-out dates
- Check-in and check-out times
- Day use or late check-out if applicable
- Inclusions
- Extra charges payable direct
- Special requests
- Special promotions.

11. What are objectives when contacting tourism businesses for product information?

- Making contact with tourism businesses
- Introducing your business to the organisation
- Identify if the tourism business 'fits' your company profile or image
- Gain an understanding of the tourism products and services they provide
- Understand their 'promotional message' and how to promote their products and services
- Discuss contractual agreements and terms and conditions for working together
- Requesting product information.

12. What are ways to make contact with tourism businesses?

- Telephoning targeted businesses
- Making face-to-face requests of sales staff that visit the office
- Making e-mail requests
- Registering to receive information, newsletters and up-dates.

13. What are methods used to interpret product information?

- Understanding resources, including interpreting codes, abbreviations, acronyms and individual supplier terminology
- Converting currencies
- Interpreting terms and conditions
- Understanding limitations and elements of products and services, especially packages and deals
- Identifying fees and charges

14. What is the purpose of reviewing and evaluating product information you have received?

- Assessing currency of the information provided
- Determining degree of usefulness of the information
- Identifying new information that is needed to supplement existing product information
- Considering the applicability of information to client queries and needs
- Judging accuracy and honesty of the information provided by suppliers.

15. What are methods used to obtain additional product information?

- Making telephone calls
- Sending e-mails
- Internet research
- Interrogation of the internal database
- Asking network of contacts
- Subscribing to industry magazines, newsletters, updates.

16. Besides contacting suppliers, what are sources of additional product information?

- Colleagues, supervisors and managers
- Representatives
- Developing your own industry network
- Networking with industry colleagues
- Conferences and seminars
- Information services
- Computerised information systems
- Accommodation guides
- Travel publications
- TV programs
- Educationals / familiarisations
- Product launches
- Trade shows
- Local community information.

17. What are considerations when loading product information into your inventory systems?

- Timing of data entry and up-dates, including up-date schedules
- Authorities to enter data, including designation of individuals and positions within the business
- Identification of specific data that must and must not be entered onto the system
- Complying with operational requirements of the data system
- Version controls to note dates material was last edited/up-dated.

18. What are examples of manual filing systems?

- Public area displays
- Back of house storage areas
- Filing cabinets
- Suspension files
- Personal information manual
- Contact details of tourism businesses.

19. What methods can be used to ensure the accuracy of product information received?

- Identify date in which current information was compiled
- Checking version of the brochure or information
- Checking on the website for accurate 'real time' information
- Contacting the supplier to verify information.

20. How can you monitor product information inventory?

- Assessing completeness, accuracy and currency of the product information
- Verifying source of information
- Monitoring bookings, allotments/allocations and requests
- Ensuring regular up-dates in accordance with supplier schedules and seasonal demands
- Ensuring all products and services offered are supported by suitable and sufficient product information inventory.

21. How can you monitor current issues relating to the travel and tourism industry?

- Attend all meetings that you are required to attend
- Read the memos
- Monitor the media
- Fine tune your own personal radar
- Form your own informed opinion
- Talk to supervisors and management
- Talk to customers.

22. What are reasons for needing additional allocations or brochures from a supplier?

- One-off peak load demand
- General trends indicating increased demand
- New promotions and packages
- Increased media awareness for a location or business - whether in the news, current affairs, documentaries etc.
- Attractive offers by complementary businesses - for example recently promoted cheap flights might lead to greater demand to one of their destinations
- Greater ease of travel - regulatory restrictions may be relaxed
- Currency exchange fluctuations.

23. What are methods use to remove out-dated product information?

- Deleting information regarding products and services that have been removed from the service menu
- Over-writing dated information with revised information
- Removing out-of-date information
- Complying with designated host enterprise guidelines
- Removing hard copy material that supports and reflects product information inventory data.

24. What are some ways suppliers may want you to remove their brochures from your offices?

- Returned to them
- Shredded or destroyed
- Marked in a manner that identifies them as invalid or out-dated
- Placed in normal waste
- Recycled in line in with organisational values.

25. What are reasons for updating product information inventories?

- Price changes
- Changes to products and services
- New packages
- Updated facilities
- New attractions
- Changes in visa requirements
- New management
- New awards
- Stories of interest
- New agreements with partner organisations.

26. What are ways to input up-dates and other product information into existing product information inventories?

- Adding new information as soon as possible
- Ensuring related hard copy material is removed or amended
- Updated with new promotional information or pages
- Amended by removing selected pages
- Ensuring accuracy of data entry.

27. Who are internal personnel whom may use product information inventories?

- Head office
- Managers, supervisors and owners
- Sales staff, including counter-staff, ticketing officers and other client-contact staff
- Marketing department
- Accounting department, including individual responsible for price setting.

28. Provide examples of how frequent product information should be passed to staff.

Answers will vary.

29. What are methods used to communicate new product information to staff?

- Formal meetings
- SOP's
- Staff briefings at the start and end of shifts
- One-on-one or group discussions
- Training sessions
- Informal communication during a shift
- Discussing new product information when it arrives
- Presentation by suppliers
- YouTube clips and videos.

30. What are examples of assistance you can provide to staff after you have given them new product information?

- Providing information as required
 - Clarifying information and information that is potentially conflicting
 - Explaining how to present information to clients
 - Making recommendations
 - Verifying information sourced by staff.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Maintain product information inventory D2.TTA.CL2.12
Dates of observation	
Instructions	1. Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: a) Identify the function of product information inventory in the travel and tourism business b) Source and interpret products and information for inventory c) Enter product information onto inventory systems d) Update product information inventory e) Supply inventory information 2. Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken 3. Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise 4. Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Identify the function of product information inventory in the travel and tourism business		
Describe the role of product information inventories	☐	☐
List the businesses involved with product information inventories	☐	☐
Identify the formats of product information inventories	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Source and interpret products and information for inventory		
Identify information that may be entered onto a product information inventory	☐	☐
Request businesses to supply required product information	☐	☐
Interpret product information received from businesses	☐	☐
Review and evaluate product information	☐	☐
Obtain additional product information, where necessary	☐	☐
Element 3: Enter product information onto inventory systems		
Load data onto the product information inventory system in accordance with host enterprise policies and procedures	☐	☐
Verify completeness, accuracy and currency of information entered onto the product information inventory	☐	☐
Element 4: Update product information inventory		
Monitor product information inventory	☐	☐
Request additional allocations	☐	☐
Remove information from product information inventory	☐	☐
Input up-dates and other product information changes as they arrive	☐	☐
Element 5: Supply inventory information		
Identify internal personnel to whom product inventory information advice may be provided	☐	☐
Identify frequency with which product inventory information advice may be provided	☐	☐
Prepare and distribute reports and product information to internal personnel	☐	☐
Provide assistance to internal personnel	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]		
Unit of competency:	Maintain product information inventory D2.TTA.CL2.12		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Identify the function of product information inventory in the travel and tourism business			
Describe the role of product information inventories	☐	☐	☐
List the businesses involved with product information inventories	☐	☐	☐
Identify the formats of product information inventories	☐	☐	☐
Element 2: Source and interpret products and information for inventory			
Identify information that may be entered onto a product information inventory	☐	☐	☐
Request businesses to supply required product information	☐	☐	☐
Interpret product information received from businesses	☐	☐	☐
Review and evaluate product information	☐	☐	☐
Obtain additional product information, where necessary	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 3: Enter product information onto inventory systems			
Load data onto the product information inventory system in accordance with host enterprise policies and procedures	☐	☐	☐
Verify completeness, accuracy and currency of information entered onto the product information inventory	☐	☐	☐
Element 4: Update product information inventory			
Monitor product information inventory	☐	☐	☐
Request additional allocations	☐	☐	☐
Remove information from product information inventory	☐	☐	☐
Input up-dates and other product information changes as they arrive	☐	☐	☐
Element 5: Supply inventory information			
Identify internal personnel to whom product inventory information advice may be provided	☐	☐	☐
Identify frequency with which product inventory information advice may be provided	☐	☐	☐
Prepare and distribute reports and product information to internal personnel	☐	☐	☐
Provide assistance to internal personnel	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**Third party signature:****Date:****Send to:**

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Maintain product information inventory	D2.TTA.CL2.12
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Identify the function of product information inventory in the travel and tourism business						
Describe the role of product information inventories						
List the businesses involved with product information inventories						
Identify the formats of product information inventories						
Element 2: Source and interpret products and information for inventory						
Identify information that may be entered onto a product information inventory						
Request businesses to supply required product information						
Interpret product information received from businesses						
Review and evaluate product information						
Obtain additional product information, where necessary						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Enter product information onto inventory systems						
Load data onto the product information inventory system in accordance with host enterprise policies and procedures						
Verify completeness, accuracy and currency of information entered onto the product information inventory						
Element 4: Update product information inventory						
Monitor product information inventory						
Request additional allocations						
Remove information from product information inventory						
Input up-dates and other product information changes as they arrive						

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 5: Supply inventory information						
Identify internal personnel to whom product inventory information advice may be provided						
Identify frequency with which product inventory information advice may be provided						
Prepare and distribute reports and product information to internal personnel						
Provide assistance to internal personnel						
Candidate signature:				Date:		
Assessor signature:				Date:		

